

Programme Handbook & Engagement Brief

Everything your team needs to run the Generation Bridge Foundation engagement

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
Document reference	MOM-2026-HB-01
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Classification	Participant material
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1. Welcome to the engagement

Your team has been retained as external strategy consultants by the Board of Generation Bridge Foundation (GBF), a Vietnamese non-profit working on youth unemployment. Over the next six weeks you will diagnose a genuine strategic problem, test your thinking against evidence, weigh difficult ethical trade-offs, and present a recommendation to the Board.

This is a simulated but realistic engagement. There is no single correct answer. You will be assessed on the quality of your thinking, the honesty of your evidence, the discipline of your teamwork, and the clarity of your communication.

Everything you need is contained in this package. You must not use external research, the internet, or any information beyond the documents, transcripts and datasets provided. Where the evidence is incomplete, say so; managing ambiguity is part of the exercise.

2. The client at a glance

Item	Detail
Organisation	Generation Bridge Foundation (Cau Noi The He)
Founded	2014, Ho Chi Minh City
Mission	Connect 16-24 year-olds who are not in education, employment or training (NEET) to dignified work
2025 budget	VND 18.2 billion
Young people served in 2025	2,847
Current waitlist (Jan 2026)	approximately 2,400
Staff	67 full-time, 12 part-time, ~340 active volunteers
Delivery hubs	Ho Chi Minh City (2), Binh Duong (1), Dong Nai (1), Long An (pilot)

3. The question the Board has asked you

"What should GBF's strategy be for 2026 to 2028, and how should we allocate our limited resources to maximise dignified youth employment outcomes?"

- Engagement letter from the GBF Board, 15 January 2026

The Board is divided. Read the client data room carefully: senior staff, the largest donor and individual board members do not agree with one another, and some of what you are told will not survive contact with the data.

4. How your team is organised: two workstreams

Every team of five or six splits into two consulting workstreams. Each workstream has its own detailed engagement brief in its own folder. Read both.

Workstream	Owns	Folder
A - Impact Strategy	Stakeholders, design thinking, strategic options, ethics, the recommendation narrative	2_Workstream_A_Impact_Strategy

B - Operations & Analytics	Data cleaning, dashboard, financial and funding analysis, impact measurement	3_Workstream_B_Operations_and_Analytics
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The two workstreams are not silos. Each must formally audit the other before anything is submitted (see the Cross-Workstream Audit Checklist in the Shared Toolkit). Neither workstream may submit a deliverable without the other's signature.

5. What you will produce

Deliverable	Owner	Format	Due
Project Charter & RACI	Whole team	Word -> PDF; Excel	Tue 14 Jul
Problem statement & issue tree	Workstream A	Word -> PDF	Wed 15 Jul
Stakeholder map	Workstream A	Word -> PDF	Thu 16 Jul
Information credibility matrix	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Thu 16 Jul
Data quality report	Workstream B	Word -> PDF	Tue 21 Jul
Empathy & journey maps	Workstream A	Word -> PDF	Wed 22 Jul
Performance dashboard	Workstream B	Excel	Fri 24 Jul
Strategic options	Workstream A	Word -> PDF	Thu 30 Jul
Funding scenarios	Workstream B	Excel	Thu 6 Aug
Validation protocol & revision log	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Thu 6 Aug
Final report	Whole team	Word -> PDF	Fri 14 Aug
Board presentation	Whole team	PowerPoint	Thu 13 Aug
Peer evaluation	Individual	Word -> PDF	Mon 17 Aug
Reflection journal	Individual	Word -> PDF	Tue 18 Aug

The complete task-by-task timeline, with owners and times, is in the Shared Toolkit workbook (GBF_Consulting_Toolkit.xlsx, tab 'Master Timeline').

6. Programme calendar

Week	Dates (2026)	Focus
1	13-17 July	Frame the problem, set up the team, assess the evidence
2	20-24 July	Clean the data, map the beneficiary, build the first dashboard
3	27-31 July	Analyse, generate options, cross-check evidence
4	3-7 August	Validate against interviews, model funding, revise
5	10-14 August	Finalise report and deck, present to the Board
6	17-21 August	Peer evaluation, reflection, debrief

7. How you will be assessed

A 100-point rubric applies. The weighting tells you where to invest effort.

Criterion	Points
Problem understanding	15
Research quality	10
Design thinking	15
Data analysis	20
Recommendations	20
Presentation	10
Project management	5
Teamwork	5

Note that data analysis is 20 points, not the majority. Strong teams use data to support judgement; they do not let it dominate the engagement.

8. Ethical dilemmas you must engage with

Workstream A must address at least three of the following in the ethical analysis template. There are no perfect answers; we assess how you reason.

Ref	Dilemma
ED-01	Should GBF prioritise easier-to-place youth to meet the VPBank placement target?
ED-02	Should the organisation report placement at 60 days instead of 90?
ED-03	Can trained volunteers replace paid field staff?
ED-04	Should GBF pilot an AI chatbot for waitlist intake?
ED-05	Should marginal funds go to prevention or intensive NEET support?
ED-06	Should graduates be steered toward placements that earn GBF Staffing Solutions a fee?

9. Ground rules

1. Use only the materials in this package. Do not invent facts or seek outside data.
2. Every claim in a deliverable must cite its source: a document reference (for example D-02), a transcript reference (for example ST-01), or a named dataset.
3. State the definitions you use, especially for the placement rate.
4. Deliverables are read as PDF, filled in as Word, analysed in Excel, and presented in PowerPoint. No other formats.
5. Your Buddy is a facilitator, not a consultant. They will ask questions and offer graduated hints, but they will not give you the answer.

10. Package contents

Folder	What is inside
0_Start_Here	This handbook, the data room index, the deadline summary
1_Client_Data_Room	GBF documents (D-01 to D-12), interview transcripts, the datasets workbook
2_Workstream_A_Impact_Strategy	Workstream A brief, design-thinking playbook, Workstream A templates
3_Workstream_B_Operations_and_Analytics	Workstream B brief, data analysis workbook, Workstream B templates
4_Shared_Toolkit	Consulting toolkit workbook, presentation guide, board deck, shared templates